

ASSABIAN RITES

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Sorcerous Lore, Spells and Skills for the Thennla Campaign Setting

Part Four: Conjuring

This article takes a step into the world of the summoner, exploring how to conjure up supernatural entities the lurk just beyond normal human perception.

The Hidden Ones are supernatural entities who reside in the fringes and hidden dimensions of the Material World. Usually invisible and immaterial, they can assume physical form under certain conditions – sometimes at will – but vanish again when they want to escape human contact. Their nature is inherently magical, to some they are the essence of magic itself and is among the most important facets of study in the Mundane Arcana. Sorcerers can learn how to summon these ethereal beings, and having done so will seek some favour or demand a service according to the balance of power between them or the bargain they can strike. These sorcerers are often known as Conjurers.

Two types of Ethereal have already been described in *Shores of Korantia* – Dryads and Satyrs. The gorgon Demuskera encountered in the *Prishad's Daughter* scenario is another example. Many more exist – from powerful Ifrit to Elves, Dwarves (Dark Elves), Trolls, Goblins, Kobolds, evil Hags and more. In many fantasy settings these creatures are simply natural denizens living alongside humans and referred to as 'non-human' or 'humanoid' races. In the Thennla setting they are inherently magical beings inhabiting a parallel space within the world normally inaccessible to humans, but who can take on physical form under certain conditions. In Assabia, a region where some of the world-building inspiration comes from the 1001 Nights, they can be called Djinn.

There are stories of how some Ethereals can be *lured* into appearing voluntarily rather than forced to appear by a conjuring spell, perhaps by setting up a place furnished with all the

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things they love the most and waiting – sometimes for years – for one to appear. So dealing with them is not simply the preserve of sorcerers.

Conjuring ethereal beings may appear similar to using an Evoke spell to call forth entities from the Spirit World or Many Hells, but it is actually quite a different practice, forcing an entity already present in the world to appear at a specific place in a physical form. Conjuring also applies to calling up elementals, and the necromantic right of conjuring the dead – these will be explored in more detail below.

The Conjuror's Grimore

A conjuror's grimoire contains either Conjure Ethereal or Conjure Elemental, as well as some appropriate Dominate invocations, possibly even Enslave (Creatures) which is useful where Goblins and Trolls are concerned. Mystic (Sense) is commonly used to attempt to locate ethereal presence before attempting the conjuring. As conjuring magic is typically derived from Dimensionalist schools, one or more spells such as Mark, Portal, Summon and Switch Body may also be present. Imprison is sometimes used to help control an Ethereal once it has materialised.

Conjuring spells usually have the Ritual Summons trait.

Ritual Summons

This spell trait indicates a casting time measured in hours of preparation and minutes for the key magical incantations. The sorcerer's player may choose to rush the preparation or ritual – incurring a skill penalty from either or both; or to take extra time and care, gaining a maximum one grade bonus to their skill. If the sorcerer subsequently reaches agreement with the summoned entity to meet with them again, then the Djinn will teach them a Folk Magic spell, Appear, with which to summon the

creature again to their presence with minimal time and Magic Point cost. The Appear spell only works when calling a specific entity, and the entity will only appear if it pleases them to do so or is in keeping with a bargain made.

BIND DJINN

Ritual Enchantment, Resist (Willpower)

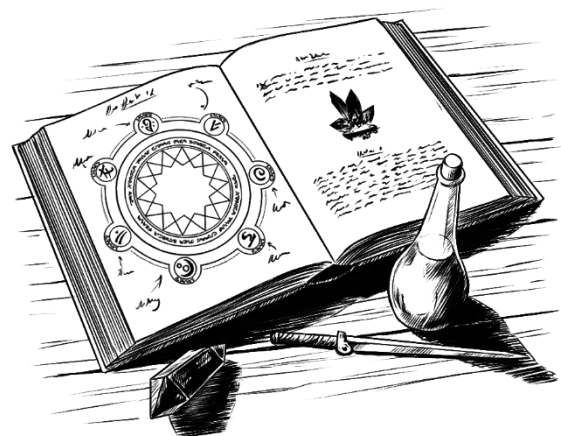
This enchantment creates a prison into which a Djinn can be forced to Vanish, only able to be released again upon the command of the caster or the expiry of the enchantment that consigns it there. The spell makes use of the Temporary Enchantment table for Duration. The enchantment produces an interdimensional space within the object so enchanted but it is a bare, soulless prison.

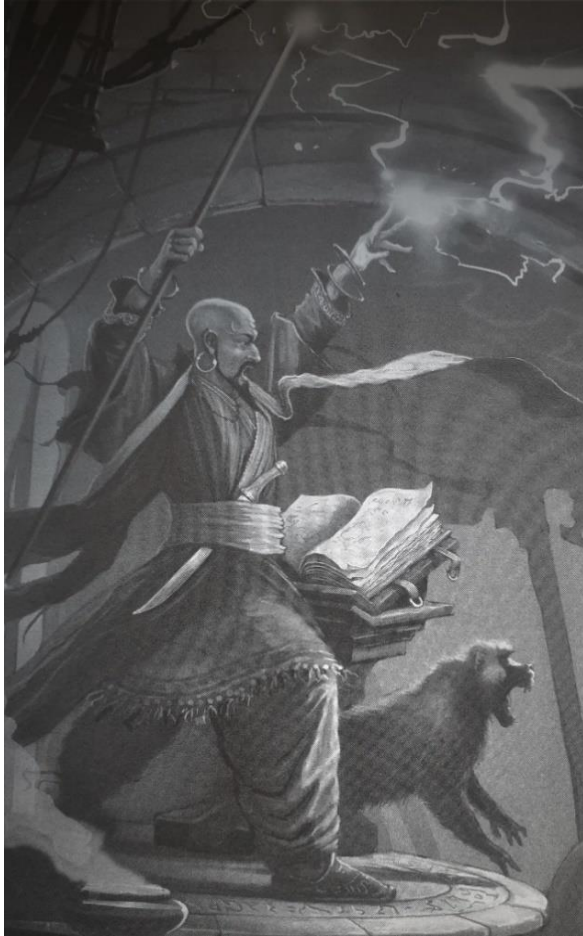
CONJURE ETHEREAL

Ritual Summons, Resist (Endurance)

This spell is used to summon any INT-based Ethereal creature.

A Conjure spell must be conducted following a ritual appropriate to the type of creature being summoned, which may be found in a Bestiary or researched by the conjuror. If the target has a Locus then the spell must have sufficient Range to reach the location where it may be found, for example the pool inhabited by a Naiad, the caverns where Trolls lurk, the





magical lamp in which an Ifrit is bound. If the summoner doesn't know where the nearest target may be, this is a difficult part to get right. Entities already materialised, incorporated or manifest cannot be affected. A Djinn cannot be conjured to a place that is hostile to its own nature – for example a Troll cannot be summoned into the daylight. Of course a malevolent magician could summon a troll into a darkened room and then throw back the blackout drapes to cause distress and injury.

The target's POW can be no more than three times the spell's Intensity, the spell's Magnitude must be equal to or greater than the Intensity of the Djinn to overcome their natural aversion and resistance to magical summons. Above all the Djinn must be in range of the spell. Once summoned the Djinn is not under the summoner's control – the only thing it cannot do is vanish again. Because the target

of the spell is present in the world, its subsequent ability to travel from the place of summoning is dictated by their traits, not by the range of the spell.

For a target with an intensity of 6 or greater, usually the most powerful Ifrit, a procedure must be used that is specific to the named individual entity being evoked. Researching such a procedure is much more difficult. Ideally it will be the subject of a quest, but if abstracted the Games Master should impose a difficulty grade to the research task of one level per Intensity in excess of 5 of the target being researched.

The spell's Duration component determines how long the materialisation will last and the Djinn may not vanish unless the spell is neutralised or cancelled. Once this has expired the Djinn does not automatically disappear, but begins to pay the cost of maintaining its physical form, and likewise must use a magic point and an action if it wishes to vanish.

CONJURE ELEMENTAL

Ritual Summons

This spell is used to summon any INS-based Elemental. The spell must have Magnitude at least equal to the volume (in cubic meters) of the elemental required. The caster must have sufficient quantities of the material from which the elemental can form its body, the exception being Flesh and Fire. A Flesh elemental can bloat and grow a small amount of flesh into its required volume, requiring 3 SIZ of flesh per cubic meter. A Fire Elemental requires 1 Intensity of fire to form per cubic meter, however an Intensity 5 fire is sufficient for any size Elemental.

Once conjured an elemental can move anywhere at its normal Movement Rate. The summoner is not in control of the Elemental, and as an INS-based creature that is also

essentially fearless she can't reason with it, so the appropriate Dominate spell is needed to get it under control.

CONJURE THE DEAD

Ritual Summons, Resist (Willpower)

The classic rite of Necromancy allows someone to question a dead spirit about something it witnessed or did in life. This procedure is almost universally frowned upon if not conducted with official approval. To call up the spirit, the conjurer needs access to the corpse it once inhabited - or a part thereof.

With a successful casting of the spell the spirit of the deceased is immediately made manifest – it can be seen as a shadowy form and can converse. The spirit cannot leave the vicinity of its corpse and can move no further than POW metres from it. The dead will generally behave themselves and engage in conversation for the Duration of the spell if they are given something they want – anything from a few Magic Points to a POW dedication, depending on how powerful, important or greedy the spirit is. News of their still living loved ones or the chance to converse with them may suffice. Otherwise they need to be commanded using a Dominate (Ghost) spell.

The POW of the target cannot be greater than three times the spell's intensity and the deceased's spirit cannot have completed its journey to its final resting place courtesy of formal funeral rites. How much time has elapsed since the spirit departed the world is also an issue; if more than a month has passed then the roll is Hard; more than a year is Formidable, and for the ancient dead who have been passed away a century or more, it is Herculean. If the corpse has been cremated in accordance with Tarsenian custom, or otherwise destroyed leaving scant remains to work with, it is immediately treated as if a year or more has passed. Apparently preservation

of the corpse itself can play a role; if some way is found to keep a corpse fresh and free of corruption it may also delay the onset of increased difficulty in summoning the spirit it once housed. Likewise if the body is excarnated and the bones scattered soon after death the reverse is true, which may account for the prevalence of these practices amongst people who do not have access to the Lay to Rest miracle.

The Conjurer only gets one attempt and if that fails he will never be able to summon up this particular dead soul.

The Conjurer's Bestiary

Most importantly the conjuror also requires a Bestiary in order to know the specific ritual procedures required for each type of entity they would conjure. These procedures cover things such as location, time of day, ritual equipment, components or even clothing required. A conjurer's personal spell book will often incorporate this information within the main text or as appendices or marginal notes, but dedicated Bestiaries are also available. If the conjuror does not have the information they need to summon a specific type they can use Lore (Mundane Arcana) to research the procedure and once that's done they can retain for future use. This can be made an extended task, with each task round being one day per Intensity of the target species. As in any research project, the quality of the library available to them for their research will affect the difficulty of the roll.

Ethereal Creatures

There are many types of Ethereal, and many are analogous to creatures described in the Mythras Core Rules Book but with some important additional traits. As supernatural entities, Ethereals are measured by Intensity in the same way as spirits. Intensity provides a

measure of its POW, being 1d6 +6 per Intensity, so for example Intensity 2 Ethereals have a POW of 1d6+12. Ethereal beings have their own hierarchies, their own kingdoms and rulers; however by the standards of humankind these are paltry affairs, and the reach of a Djinn lord is more akin to the head of a cult or faction exercising authority over a power structure through a network of henchmen and minions. A Djinn is often restricted to a specific locale or must observe certain rules affecting where they can go or when and where they can materialise. If a Djinn is forced outside of those it begins to fade at a rate of one Magic Point per hour until it ceases to exist. A Djinn can be destroyed if it does not vanish before its Magic Points are exhausted, and it can be destroyed by being killed while material. Some types will recur if their home territory is left undisturbed, others can be destroyed by the destruction of their physical locus – for example cutting down a hamadryad's tree will permanently destroy the hamadryad too. To all intents and purposes Djinn are otherwise immortal.

Materialising and Vanishing

The Djinn's natural state is intangible and invisible. This is not the same as inhabiting the Spirit World, because it remains present in the Material World, and if detected can be targeted with spells etc. To create a physical form ('Materialising') is an act of will that requires the spending of a Magic Point, and dissipating the physical form ('vanishing') likewise requires an action and a Magic Point. The Djinn cannot perform both operations in a single round.

Maintaining a material form costs one Magic Point per hour. Consequently Djinn do not materialise without a purpose nor hang around longer than necessary. However there are circumstances where the Djinn is on 'home territory' and the cost of maintaining a physical

form is significantly less. For example, Trolls can maintain their form at no cost during night hours.

Dimensional Homes

Some types of Djinn have a home that is experienced as physical but is nowhere in the physical space offered by the Material World. Only the Djinn knows how to find and get access to this place, however it can bring one non-ethereal entity with it for each level of Intensity. These places require permanent dedications of Magic Points to produce and maintain, so not every Djinn can afford one, and some such places are created as communal efforts, for example a gang of goblins may create their own enchanted cavern to be their home. Such places are Djinn-friendly, and cost ethereal entities no magic points to maintain their own form while they are within.

Locus

There is a physical place or area in the mundane world to which the Djinn is connected, and within POW Meters of which it can use its magical abilities without manifesting. For a Dryad this is her grove, a Kobold may be the barn or store on a remote farmstead. The Djinn usually cannot leave its locus without materialising, and even then may not stray further than POW meters from its locus without starting to lose Magic Points. If the locus is destroyed it may spell doom for the djinn, however some have the recurring trait and reappear in a new locus some time after destruction of the old one. If a Djinn has a Locus, then the locus must be in range of the Conjuring spell to be effective.

Conditions

Djinn are to some extent living enchantments, and as such they are subject to conditions. These conditions may limit what a Djinn can do and where it can go, but they also must observe many taboos that may be rather

The Language of Magic

Some Ethereals speak human languages – in fact those who have lived very long lives may speak many languages including some that humans have forgotten. But all speak and understand the Language of Magic, which sorcerers generally only encounter in the strange words, phrases and sounds that are part of their invocations. Properly name Anasmadine, it is called by many The Old Tongue, invented in some long past age before the gods made people. Very few humans have ever mastered it, and any communication is necessarily one grade of difficulty harder because the sounds and tones needed are often beyond human range.

obscure or pointless to humankind. Among these taboos is an absolute injunction against compelling a creature of free will, such as a human being, to love, obedience or submission through magic. Hence to achieve their ends they must resort to guile, threat or bargain.

Binding Djinn

Djinn can be bound, but this is a state of affairs they really do not like at all. While bound they are powerless to act unless called forth by their binder (or whoever has control of the binding object), unable to regain any spent Magic Points, to heal wounds, or perceive the world. If called forth from its binding, a Djinn will immediately attack the summoner unless it is clear the summoner has the ability to summarily return them to their binding, or has some sort of dominate spell to hand.

A bound Djinn can be bargained with, and will gladly perform a service demanded of it (that is within their capability) in return for release from their binding and destruction of the binding enchantment or object at completion of the task.

Elfkind (*Intensity 1*)

Diminutive elves that are interested in the material world but prefer not to be seen. They come in several varieties and are known by several names according to the Locus they can be found in:

- Sprites, found in lonely and desolate places,
- Pixies, found in wildernesses or around trees and other vegetation,
- Nixies, found in watery places,
- Kobolds, found in human habitations
- Goblins, found in underground places (see example below).

Capable of shapechanging into small creatures such as weasels, foxes and cats, but also into larger ones such as horses, stags or oxen, an Elfkind's shapechanged form always has some tell-tale feature (for example an outlandish colour, or misplaced feature) that will alert the wary observer to the fact that this is not the real deal. For this reason they never imitate humans, as humans can spot a fake among their own kind so easily.

When shapechanging the Elfkind can double its SIZ or halve it for 1 Magic Point. For two Magic Points it can triple its SIZ or reduce it by two thirds; and for three magic points it can quadruple its SIZ or reduce it by three quarters. In each case its STR will adjust proportionately.

They usually have access to a range of Folk Magic spells to a maximum of half POW.

Elfkind will do anything not to be at personal risk in a combat situation, and are not

particularly aggressive; however they can be very mean-spirited, happy to bring misfortune, accident and disaster to those who cross them.

Elfkind can make fine servants for a sorcerer, if given access to conditions that suit their lifestyle. Dominate Elfkind is a readily

accessible spell in Conjuring grimoires compared to those for more powerful types of Ethereal.

Statistics are provided here for one of the more common types of Elfkind – the Goblin:

Goblin (Intensity 1)

Goblins are deceivers, thieves and compulsive hoarders. They can be very mean-spirited, happy to bring misfortune, accident and disaster to those who cross them. But if caught they can sometimes be forced to reveal their treasures to earn their release. A goblin's home territory is an underground lair, the

entrance to which is entirely invisible by day and requires a herculean Perception roll by night even if actively searching. Goblins can only venture above ground if they materialise (assume physical form), and can only do this at night at the cost of one Magic Point. In order to dematerialise again they must return to their den or another underground hideaway. If caught in daylight goblins bleed away one magic point per hour even in gloomy shade; in direct sunlight they take 1d3 magic points damage per round.

Goblins are not particularly aggressive; however they will do anything (no matter how vicious) not to be at personal risk in a combat

<i>Goblin</i>					
	<i>Dice</i>	<i>Average</i>	<i>1D20</i>	<i>Hit Location</i>	<i>AP/HP</i>
STR	1d6+6	10	01-03	Right Leg	0/4
CON	3d6	11	04-06	Left Leg	0/4
SIZ	2d6	7	07-09	Abdomen	0/5
INT	2d6+6	13	10-12	Chest	0/6
POW	1d6+6	10	13-15	Right Arm	0/3
DEX	2d6+6	13	16-18	Left Arm	0/3
CHA	3d6	11	19-20	Head	0/4
Actions					3
Damage Modifier					-1d2
Initiative Bonus					13
Magic Points					10
Movement					4m
<i>Skills:</i> Commerce 25%, Deceit 64%, Endurance 44%, Insight 63%, Perception 55%, Sleight 64%, Stealth 66%, Willpower 39%					
<i>Combat Style:</i> Goblin Rage (club, dagger, scimitar, buckler, dart) 44%. Most goblins' weapons have a -1 step penalty to Size and Reach					
<i>Folk Magic (POW x4):</i> A goblin has access to a number of Folk Magic spells equal to half its POW from among the following: Babble, Beastcall, Befuddle, Bypass, Curse, Darkness, Dishevel, Dullblade, Extinguish, Find (Gold, Jewels), Knock, Mindspeech, Pathway, Pierce, Polish, Preserve, Repair, Shove, Ventriloquism					
<i>Traits:</i> Elusive. Deceit, Sleight and Stealth rolls are one grade easier (this advantage does not stack with other positive modifiers). Shapeshifter. Goblins are capable of shapechanging, preferring above all to morph into huge beetles or spiders. Locus. Goblins make their home in caves and other underground places.					

situation unless they have stacked the odds in their favour through magic and guile. If a goblin takes a serious wound it will immediately seek an opportunity to escape to its den, and in doing so may inadvertently reveal its entrance.

Conjuring Goblins: Goblins often operate in gangs and when conjuring the Targets manipulation can be used to cause as many to appear as desired. Goblins are susceptible to the Enslave (Goblins) sorcery spell, and their resistance roll is one grade of difficulty harder. Goblins can be bargained with for a service, they usually want some treasure – jewels are valued over gold and silver. They find secrets – passages, tunnels, hidden doors and ways.

Elf (Intensity 2)

Elves are of similar kind to nymphs yet not bound to a specific locale, and can be male, female or non-binary. They are clever, charismatic, highly skilled and more than capable of outsmarting a human. Comfortable blending in among humans an elf is a potential go-between for humans and other ethereals. Elves are often called upon by conjurers to bring good fortune, but their physical beauty and ability to pass themselves as human (and to produce a glamour) has other attractions and uses. Elves can be found hiding in plain sight in human company. In Assabia it is often said that if you are in a city you are never more than a 100 meters from an Elf. They enjoy the material life, and except when forced to vanish by some emergency only spend time away from it as a means to control and slow the ageing process, resulting in a typical life-span of 2-300 years. Only one elf is normally encountered at any time. Meetings between elves are rare and always have an air of formality.

Elf Characteristics are as provided in the Mythras Core Rulebook except POW is 1d6+12 and CHA is 2D6+9. Elf skills are as provided in

Mythras, plus Disguise (as human) 64%. In addition every Elf has mastery (usually 4 x Basic) of at least one rare or Professional skill, suitable examples being the following: Art; Courtesy; Language (Any, including esoteric ones), Lore (Mundane Arcana); Ride (exotic creature); Seduction; Shaping. Alternatively a rather specialist combat style, such as one which comes with the Flying Mount trait, or an especially rare Duelling style.

Conjuring Elves: Because elves spend as much time as possible materialised, and the resting places and retreats when vanished are hard to find (unless perhaps you can enlist a Goblin to help you), conjuring one can be a challenge. However they can be discovered in human company, either through detective work or magic. Sense Elf is a sorcery spell available from several grimoires.

Elves can be impressed into service using a Dominate Elf spell, but this risks the Elf doing everything it can to thwart its controller's ambitions by twisting and undermining the instructions they are given. However they sometimes attach themselves voluntarily to a humans as advisor, friend or even lover, and they can anyway be bargained with to provide a service or favour, often as a teacher or mentor. Above all they can be the source of a new Professional Skill that is so rare or exotic that no mundane human teacher can be found.

Elves are sought after because they often possess the means to change a human's fortunes for the better. In a way they can take it on themselves to grant a human their wish. But that can't be achieved by a magical wave of the hand.

Rags to Riches: The Elf conspires to raise the mortal's Social Class. Possessed of no property

of its own and unable to create out of nothing, the Djinn can either share the secret of access to hidden treasure, or use its powers and skills to influence someone of status to bestow wealth and position on their mortal friend.

Success in Love: The Djinn cannot make one mortal fall in love with another, but it can have insight, seduction and even deceit through which it can advise and encourage a mortal to pursue their heart's desire in ways that are most likely to be successful.

Arcane Secrets: The Elf instructs the sorcerer in magical lore, usually Lore (Mundane Arcana) and prepares him for some important quest - or simply for advancement at one of the Courts.

Dark Elf (Intensity 3)

Sometimes referred to as Drow or Dwarf, a Dark Elf is a solitary creature that shuns human contact. Unlike other elves, a Dark Elf lurks in dark and lonely places and delves amongst the secrets and mysteries of the earth and is perhaps found in company with goblin assistants.

Encounters with Drow tend to bring ill luck rather than good in the long run, nevertheless they are known as fabulous craftsmen and enchanters, and have produced enchanted items that few human sorcerers can compete with.

Dark Elf Characteristics are as for Elves except their POW is 1d6+18 and their CHA is 3d6.

In addition to the usual skills for an Elf as provided in the CRB, every Dark Elf has the following: Craft (any) 108%, Lore (Mundane Arcana) 96%, Invoke 111%, Shaping 96%

Magic: A Dark Elf will know Enchant (Object), Golem Characteristic, Object of Virtue, plus 1d6 other Sorcery spells. A Dark Elf will also know 1d6+6 Folk Magic spells.

Half Elves

The most common examples of a child born to a union between mortal and ethereal are those of a human male and a nymph, or a male elf and a human woman. A child born of mortal and Djinn has a number of its characteristics equal to the Intensity of the Djinn parent rolled on D8 (or 2d8+8 for INT or SIZ). However should any of those rolls exceed human maximum (21) it will be spirited away to become Djinn like its magical parent.

Conjuring Dark Elves: Dark Elves are rare and hard to track down, but they often vanish for decades, even centuries, of sleep, so if the location of one can be revealed there is a good chance the Drow is sleeping and therefore can be summoned. They are invariably annoyed by the intrusion and hostile to the conjuror.

A Dark Elf can be pressed into service by magic or threat, but a Dark Elf that is forced into service will not rest until it has found vengeance on the perpetrator, and that vengeance is likely to be grossly disproportionate. They can be bargained with. A simple and trivial (for the Dark Elf) service is to craft an exquisite item. Something made a Dark Elf to an Acceptable level always has at least one enhancement, two if Good, and three if Excellent. A suit of armour, a piece of jewellery, even a piece of furniture. If all that is requested is the Dark Elf's crafting genius, then the price may be double the quantity of the materials required so the Dark Elf can make another for their own use or purposes. But they are also often master enchanters. While they will not sacrifice anything of their own to power an enchantment, they can take

from whoever they serve. Tapped Characteristic points are never acceptable. A Dark Elf can reverse the Object of Virtue spell

so that an enchanted item works against rather than for its owner. Appropriate demands for enchanting services include a captive human child, a promise that involves an impossible moral compromise, a secret the Drow wants to know (that they can use in some bigger plan). A Dark Elf's curse is frequently of knowledge - to reveal a truth that is best left unknown, something that cannot but cause strife unless the recipient demonstrates extreme wisdom and forbearance. This may be knowledge of the future - perhaps even of the self-fulfilling kind.

Ifrit (Intensity 5+)

The Dukes of the Ethereal world, the natural form of Ifrit is that of a 10m tall giant. Some Ifrit are even bigger: add +3 STR, +6 SIZ and +6POW per additional Intensity over 5. Size can be an inconvenience and an Ifrit will often use Diminish SIZ in order to operate closer to human scale. An Ifrit has mastery over elementals, of at least two types. Some relate to Earth and Fire, others to Air and Water or Fire and Air, and some have exotic relationships such as Flesh and Fire. The Ifrit can change itself into these types of elementals of up to 1Cubic Meter in size per Magic Point spent in the transformation, to a maximum of its own Intensity in Cubic Meters. It can also conjure these elementals with a casting time of one turn.

Ifrit often own or guard some major magical treasure, and they may impart magical secrets - such as a new spell, rite or grimoire, in return for what they want. Ifrit with an Intensity of 6 or more are sufficiently powerful to produce Miracles and bestow Gifts. An Ifrit has a chance equal to its POW of having a Theist Miracle it can cast at will. The Ifrit's great weakness is that it can be bound to servitude, the consequence of some god-given curse from a distant age.



Troll (Intensity 2)

Essentially a large brutal and supernaturally stupid elf, capable of feats of extraordinary Strength and Endurance, but once materialised are extraordinarily greedy. Sorcerers may like to have Trolls bound to his service as an alternative to the costly process of creating a golem, however if cheaper to conjure than a golem is to produce they are very expensive to maintain, demanding up to 15SP each in food and drink per day. They are happy to devour uncooked meat, and may even fall hungrily upon a live animal if that's what they get.

Trolls are great hulking beasts standing over 2m tall even with their hunched posture in which their head hangs forward and their great powerful arms practically drag their knuckles on the ground. Due to their size and strength they can use oversize weapons in combat.

<i>Ifrit</i>					
	Dice	Average	1D20	Hit Location	AP/HP
STR	2d6+24	31	01-03	Right Leg	5/12
CON	4d6	14	04-06	Left Leg	5/12
SIZ	2d6+39	46	07-09	Abdomen	5/13
INT	2d6+9	16	10-12	Chest	5/14
POW	d6+30	34	13-15	Right Arm	5/11
DEX	3d6	11	16-18	Left Arm	5/11
CHA	3d6+6	17	19-20	Head	5/12
Actions					3
Damage Modifier					+1d8+1d6
Initiative Bonus					14
Magic Points					34
Movement					16m
Skills: Athletics 44%, Endurance 56%, Invoke 128%, Perception 76%, Seduction 85%, Shaping 102%, Stealth 55%, Willpower 80%					
Combat Styles: Unarmed 50%; Giant Blade 55%					
Sorcery (Invocation 128%, Shaping 102%): Animate (Substance), Dimensional Palace*, Diminish SIZ, Enlarge, Enslave (not humans), Fly, Haste, Hide Life, Conjure (Elemental), Imprison, Mark, Portal, Sculpt (substance), Shapechange, Shrink, Store Manna, Summon, Teleport, Trap Soul					
Traits: Elemental (Can transform into either of two types of elemental at 1 cubic meter per point of Intensity), Soul Jar (an Ifrit keeps a magical talisman hidden away at which it can reform if physically destroyed)					
*Dimensional Palace creates an artificial space only accessible by the Ifrit or those whom it specifically admits, which has a volume equal to three times the intensity of the spell, cubed, in cubic meters. Using the Targets manipulation multiplies the volume available.					

Troll statistics can be found in the Mythras Core Rule book.

Conjuring Trolls: Trolls only ever appear in threes. If one troll is somehow destroyed its two companions immediately begin to fade at a rate of 1 MP per round. Nobody knows why. So Conjuring Trolls requires 2 points of shaping to be allocated to Targets. The Darkness Bond of each troll in the trio should be rolled independently.



Nymph (Variable Intensity)

A nymph is a supernatural entity that is bound to a locus in the Material Plane, in almost all cases a natural feature such as a pool or spring, woodland grove, mountain, meadow or stream. When a nymph manifests in physical form she appears as a beautiful

human woman, but there will always be tell-tale signs that she is somehow supernatural as her inhuman level of POW and CHA shines through.

Nymphs have a long history of interaction with humans, and even celebrate marriage with mortal men. The children of such unions are generally mortal, but often have at least one enhanced Characteristic, and perhaps a Gift or exceptional talent. A nymph is not always friendly, and will use her power against those who she considers to be a threat to natural features and creatures in her care - or even just towards those who offend her personally.

The exact type and boundaries of her territory depend on the landscape or feature concerned. A nymph can exercise her powers - using Folk Magic and controlling the creatures who live there - within a range of POW x 10m from the central point of her locus without manifesting physically. Beyond this limit, and up to the extent of her territory at POW x100m from her locus, she must manifest physically to act. If a nymph ever travels beyond this limit she will begin to fade, losing 1MP per hour and unable to regain Magic Points until she returns home. When her Magic Points reach 1 she automatically dematerialises and returns to her locus. The only way the nymph can be taken away from her locus in spirit form is if she is bound.

Nymphs are powerful in their home environment, can manifest at will and can use Beastcall and Pet on any INS-driven creature that lives there no matter what its SIZ. Some nymphs are capable of turning themselves into an Elemental, usually an Undine or Gnome,

<i>Nymph</i>					
	<i>Dice</i>	<i>Average</i>	<i>1D20</i>	<i>Hit Location</i>	<i>AP/HP</i>
STR	3d6	11	01-03	Right Leg	0/6
CON	3d6+6	17	04-06	Left Leg	0/6
SIZ	3d6	11	07-09	Abdomen	0/7
INT	2d6+12	19	10-12	Chest	0/8
POW	d6+18	22	13-15	Right Arm	0/5
DEX	2d6+6	13	16-18	Left Arm	0/5
CHA	3d6+6	17	19-20	Head	0/6
					3
					-
					16
Armour: Horned head, shaggy hide on legs					22
					8m
<i>Skills:</i> Athletics 65%, Endurance 68%, Locale 152%, Perception 76%, Seduction 85%, Stealth 55%, Willpower 110%					
<i>Combat Styles:</i> Unarmed 45%					
<i>Folk Magic (POWx4%):</i> Avert, Beastcall, Breath, Curse, Darkness, Extinguish, Heal, Incognito, Countermagic, Fate, Heal, Light, Mindspeech, Pathway, Pet, Phantasm, Protection, Witchsight					
A nymph will know a number of Folk Magic spells equal to half her INT					

with a SIZ of 1 cubic metre per Magic Point spent.

A nymph knows Folk Magic and as these are inherent abilities she casts these spells at her POW x4%.

Hag

One way a nymph divorces her own power from the state of health of her locus is by evolving into a hag. Hags are thankfully rare, corrupted and evil nymphs who generally have a bad attitude towards humans and many other forms of life. Hags have similar Characteristics to their more benign sisters, but may have claws, a venomous bite, a set of offensive spells and curses, and sometimes even control over undead creatures rather than the local wildlife.

These creatures exert malevolent influence. Even other Djinn fear their power or at least their propensity for using it to do harm to others. Like the related class of Nymphs there are many types of Hags that can be encountered or conjured:

A **Crone** is known for her wisdom; she is impossibly old and has seen or heard many



Powerful Nymphs, Weaker Nymphs

The statistics provided are for a mid-range Nymph such as a Dryad or Naiad (Intensity 3). Nymphs can have a greater or lesser POW depending on their type and natural habitat. Some examples:

<i>Nymph Species</i>	<i>Home</i>	<i>Intensity</i>	<i>POW</i>
Hamadryad	A tree	1	1d6 up to 1d6+6
Hydriad	A pool	1	1d6 up to 1d6+6
Alseid	A grove	2	1d6+12
Leimoniad	A meadow	2	1d6+12
Dryad	A forest	3	1d6+18
Naiad	A spring or river	3	1d6+12 up to 1d6+30
Nereid	A coast, shore or cove	3	1d6+18
Lampad	A cavern complex	3	1d6+18
Oread	A mountain	4 (or greater)	1d6+24
Oceanid or Merid	The open sea	5 (or greater)	1d6+30
Potamid	A River	5 (or greater)	1d6+30

things and forgotten nothing. Her gift, therefore, is knowledge

A **Norn** or **Fate** is a creature that can see the possible outcomes that can befall a person or even a kingdom. Her gift is prophecy.

A **Fury** is an avenging angel, capable of travelling the world in pursuit of a transgressor of some dread taboo.

A **Witch** keeps and exploits magical secrets. More powerful than her mortal sisters, the witch-Djinn is capable of spirit trance as well as spell-casting, and is much feared. Her gift is power. A witch can curse a pregnancy, even one that has yet to be; this could take the form of progeny that has the cursed characteristics rolled using a d4 instead of a d6.

A **Grave-Wraith** is a hag that makes graveyards her haunt, and will inflict her curses upon those who trespass upon and defile her home.

Satyr (Silenus) Intensity 2

A 'woodland' or 'wild' elf, rare in Assabia as their natural forest habitat is almost non-existent, but classified as a Djinn nonetheless. Satyrs are chaotic and unpredictable in nature, and cannot be relied on. Those who do summon them usually have very specific purposes in mind. A satyr is the male equivalent of a nymph, an ethereal creature that takes on humanoid form – if always betrayed by bestial features such as excessive hair, shaggy or even goat-like legs and animal-like genitalia and horns. Like nymphs, there are different types of satyr, and some may have special traits and characteristics. Satyrs are rightly feared by mortals – they are capricious, lustful and dangerous entities. Usually a single

<i>Satyr</i>					
	<i>Dice</i>	<i>Average</i>	<i>1D20</i>	<i>Hit Location</i>	<i>AP/HP</i>
STR	4d6+6	20	01-03	Right Leg	2/7
CON	3d6+6	17	04-06	Left Leg	2/7
SIZ	4d6	14	07-09	Abdomen	0/8
INT*	2d6+3	10	10-12	Chest	0/9
POW	4d6	14	13-15	Right Arm	0/6
DEX	3d6+6	17	16-18	Left Arm	0/6
CHA	2d6	7	19-20	Head	2/7
Actions					3
Damage Modifier					+1D4
Initiative Bonus					17
Magic Points					14
Movement					6m
<i>Skills:</i> Athletics 65%, Endurance 85%, Language (nearest human population) 35%, Locale 80%, Play Instrument 95%, Stealth 55%, Survival 125%, Track 80% , Willpower 30%					
<i>Combat Styles:</i> Unarmed 65%, Club 55%					
<i>Folk Magic (POW x3%):</i> Befuddle, Bludgeon, Demoralise, Glamour, Might, Pathway, Tune, Ventriloquism, Vigor					
<i>Traits:</i> Animal Instinct (satyrs have an INS score equal to their INT+6 that is used to calculate SR and Actions); Passions (Overindulgence, Lechery at 50+INS% each), which can be a satyr's undoing.					

individual is encountered, but there are times and places when satyrs gather together to feast and fornicate, and anything up to a dozen may be met with. Satyrs have strange, chaotic

natures and without the direction of a more powerful spirit are as likely to start fighting amongst themselves as to band together and act in a co-ordinated fashion.

A satyr can form a body at will at the cost of 1 Magic Point, but only if it is in a wild place - and away from human sight. A satyr can roam the land, and is not restricted to an area or feature in the way that a nymph is. However they represent the untamed and unfettered rule of nature, and will never come closer than within 1km of human habitation - which is sometimes a frustration, for their one weakness for human civilisation is a love of beer and wine. Offerings of fine alcoholic beverages are a good way for a traveller to ensure the satyrs leave him alone when crossing some lonely wilderness. It is similarly not unheard of to leave a condemned woman or a slave girl as an offering to the satyrs. Satyrs are also known to prize relations with human women, whom they regard as low-grade substitutes for the nymphs who so rarely favour satyrs with their attentions, but as far more interesting than satisfying their prodigious sexual drives with the local flora and fauna.

Many Satyrs have some kind of horn or flute, with which they can create both music and a bizarre range of unsettling and affecting sounds with magical effects. Each such effect takes a full round to activate, costs 1MP and requires a successful Play Instrument skill test, opposed by the target's Willpower. As he continues to play he can force a new target to resist the power of his music at the end of each subsequent round. Some people actively seek the effects of Satyrical Music, and attempt to summon a satyr to play for them.

Satyrical Music Effects

A Satyr can use his instrument to perform one of the following miraculous effects: Beast

Form, Berserk, Corruption, Enthrall, Fear, Madness. The Magnitude and Intensity of the miracle is equal to half the Satyr's POW.

Satyrs have access to Folk Magic and may know a number of cantrips up to half their POW.

Sea Satyr (Triton)

Tritons are the aquatic equivalent of the land-bound Satyr. A Triton is similarly part-human in appearance but with rough shark-like skin below the waist, gills set below the ears and hair like matted kelp. It uses a conch shell instead of a horn or pipes, and a blast upon the shell can produce miraculous effects – a version of the Earthquake miracle that can toss a vessel about upon the waves, Call Winds to stir up the waves, or Cloud Call to summon a sea fog. Instead of a club a Triton is usually armed with a trident of magically shaped and hardened coral, and may be riding a sea creature of suitable size.

A Triton has legs terminating in fins, but when it emerges from the sea these can transform to serviceable feet. Nevertheless a Triton cannot voluntarily dematerialise when out of water, and if he travels more than his POW in metres from the ocean he will lose 1 MP per hour and begins to suffer the effects of dehydration after only CONx1 hours, with a dehydration rate of *Hourly*. There is a sea captain called Settrik the Diver from Othrikor who is rumoured to be a Triton in human guise, but nobody has ever managed to learn the truth of these rumours from Settrik or his crew.

Naturally, Tritons can only be conjured out of the salt water ocean. They are creatures of the wild open waters, so a difficulty grade should be applied if conjuring in an inlet like the Gulf of Taskay, or close to coastal settlements.

Elementalists

Usually of the Materialist philosophical school, Elementalists are specialist conjurers. An

Elementalist's grimoire will usually contain the required bestiary information for at least two types of elemental; Banish; one or more Dominate (specific elemental) spells; and possibly Transmogrify (Element to Element) alongside the Conjure Elemental spell.

Flesh Elemental (Blemmye)

Blemmyes are elementals of flesh, their bodies a formless blob with a yellowish red-veined surface, capable of extending limbs and skeins of flesh or forming organs at will. A Blemmye may form in any fleshy body that is at least 3 SIZ per cubic meter of its final volume. It can extrude itself if the body in which it formed is larger than the elemental, or if smaller, it can (uniquely) grow to its full volume in the course of a single round. A Blemmye can shift its shape to match that of the creature in which it originally incorporated, although it will not be a convincing representation, its surface remaining a rather blobby wet pinkish yellow. Alternatively its summoner can force it into a certain form using form/set flesh.

A blemmye can incorporate within a living creature or person, and can become an extension of their body. They remain separate entities, but the combined forms will have hit locations apportioned according to SIZ (assume 10 SIZ per cubic meter of its volume). It can also act as a life support system for another creature within which it has incorporated, keeping it alive as long as the Elemental has positive hit points at least equal to the extent of damage the creature has received. In this state the blemmye can also absorb and excrete toxins in the incorporated creature's body.

Combat

A blemmye usually attacks by engulfing its victim in its own mass or creating fleshy limbs or tentacles to strike or grab a foe.

Characteristics & Attributes

A Blemmye's Characteristics are calculated in the same way as for all Elementals.

Necromancy

Properly speaking, necromancy is the use of sorcery to contact and treat with the dead in order to learn about the future. Since the dead don't actually know any more about the future than the living do, what it really involves is asking them to reveal what they do know about the past and present that still has currency, and can be used to influence future outcomes.

Necromancy often gets a bad name, but in real life Necromancers rarely retreat to some crypt-like hideaway to obsess over creating legions of undead. Indeed, playing with the rotting physical remains of the dead is largely missing the point, unless the purpose is to acquire a staff of completely obedient but rather dumb servants and night-watchmen who don't require food or pay. There is also a certain cachet if one's intention is to terrify clients and rivals, or keep the curious at bay. On the other hand, attempting to prevent a dead soul from leaving the mundane world, or to recombine a spirit with dead flesh, is a classic necromantic pursuit but these can also be the hallmarks of a sorcerer who has completely lost all touch with his humanity.

Necromancers need access to a specific conjuring spell which is used to reach out to the souls of the dead that have not yet reached their final destination.

Conjure the Dead is usually found in a grimoire with supporting spells such as Banish, Mystic (Sense), Protective Ward and Spirit Resistance. A high level Necromancy Grimoire may also contain Hide Life.

Coming Up Next...

Evocations – summoning spirits and demons from beyond the material world